



ingenious idea. Hermes cut up the intestines and then located a tortoise shell. He strung the guts across it and plucked them as strings. Clear notes rang out!

*Hermes had crafted the first lyre.*

Eventually, Apollo discovered Hermes with his cows. He was furious. “How dare you kill one of my prize cows!” Apollo roared.

Thinking quickly, Hermes held up the lyre he had made. “I’m sorry, Apollo,” Hermes said. “Please take this instrument in return for your cow.”

When Apollo played the lyre, the sound it produced was so beautiful the flowers and trees swayed along to the music. Apollo felt this gift was a fair trade for his cow, and he forgave Hermes. From that day on, Apollo was rarely without his tuneful lyre.

